



IUT 12th ICT Fest Datathon 2026 RULEBOOK



BrainLab presents **Datathon** at the **IUT 12th ICT Fest 2026**, powered by **Institute of Policy Dynamics**, a data science competition designed to strengthen participants' skills in data analysis, machine learning, and artificial intelligence.

Competition Description

This year's challenge will focus on **Bengali Large Language Models (LLMs)**, encouraging participants to develop innovative solutions for real-world language technology problems.

Eligibility Criteria

- Teams can consist of up to 4 members.
- Participant must be a currently enrolled undergraduate student from any recognized university in Bangladesh.
- To verify student status, each participant must submit a valid student ID card during registration.
- International teams are allowed, but at least one team member must be Bangladeshi.
- Cross-university teams are allowed
- Recent graduates are eligible if they sat for the HSC (or equivalent) examination in 2020 or later and completed their final undergraduate examinations after December 2025. Supporting documents may be requested for verification.

Participation Process

Fill up the registration form while keeping the following points in mind:

1. Team size: 1-4 members from any university.
2. The team must assign a team leader with whom all sorts of communication will be done via email.
3. This will be a private kaggle competition.
4. Ensure that the email address provided has a valid kaggle account associated with it for each team member.
5. The registration fee for each team is 600 tk.
6. The Kaggle link will be given after the registration when competition launches

Registration Link: <https://iutictfest26.tech/datathon>

Registration Timeline

- Registration Starts: 19th June
- Registration Ends: 30 June
- Any participant can register in between this time frame

Event Timeline

- Preliminary/Online round: 1 July - 20 July
- Preliminary Round Paper and Notebook Submission Deadline - 21 July
- Final Round Participants Announcement - 23 July
- Final/Onsite round: 25 July

Overall Timeline

Event	Date
Registration Starts	19th June , 2026
Datathon starts	1st July, 2026
Registration Closes	30 June, 2026
Online Round Closes	20th July, 2026
Paper and Notebook Submission	21st July, 2026
Final Round Participants Announcement	23rd July, 2026
Final Presentation and Prize Giving	25th July, 2026

Rules and Guidelines

- Only one account per participant in Kaggle will be allowed.
- All teams must have unique participants and no participant can be a member of multiple teams.
- It will be a 25 day long competition with multiple phases.
- No private code sharing outside teams.

Models, Training and Compute Rules

Pretrained Models

Publicly available **open-source pretrained models** are allowed, provided they are appropriately licensed.

Participants must disclose:

- Model name and version with repository link
- License information
- Claimed pretraining data (as stated by the model authors)

Fine-Tuning

Fine-tuning of pretrained models is permitted.

API Prohibition

The use of **any external API** is strictly prohibited. This includes, but is not limited to, OpenAI, Claude, or any hosted services.

All inference must be performed **locally within Kaggle notebooks**.

External Infrastructure

External infrastructure may be used for **training purposes only**.

Final submissions must be **fully reproducible on Kaggle**.

4.5 External Data Policy

The use of external data is allowed under the following conditions:

- The data must be publicly available, curated from public sources, or created during the competition runtime.
- All external data must be clearly declared and made public with proper citations.
- External data must **not** include or be derived from any competition test set.

Submission Requirements

Each team must submit:

- A **training notebook** (Preferred to be Kaggle-runnable) - If applicable
- An **inference notebook** (Must be Kaggle-runnable and capable of generating the final submission)
- Participants must submit a script to run the code. Submissions will not be considered if the script is not provided.
- Model checkpoints or weights (preferably hosted on Hugging Face)
- Clear documentation (README within the notebook or markdown cells)
- A video presentation of a maximum of 7 minutes (Just Methodology) has to be submitted within the competition deadline
- Participants need to submit a 4-page report following the IEEE paper format I
- Teams are strongly encouraged to upload their paper to [arXiv](#) or github and submit the corresponding link.

Re-run Policy:

All submissions will be rerun on both the public and hidden test sets after Phase 1 concludes. The inference notebook must execute within Kaggle runtime limits (CPU or GPU, as permitted).

Submission Limit:

Will be set when the competition launches.

- Submissions will be evaluated based on the following criteria:
 1. Models accuracy and efficacy of data interpretation.
 2. Inference result.
 3. Video Presentation and comprehensive report.
 4. Functional script of the code
- Participants must refrain from any form of plagiarism or unethical practices. All work must be original, and proper credit must be given to external sources if used.
- Manually labelling inference data is strictly prohibited and will result in disqualification.

NOTE: The authority has the prerogative to make conclusive decisions at any point during the entire competition duration.

NOTE: Use of common sense is highly recommended. Idiotic and deliberate mistakes like idea sharing between teams or trying to submit anything without joining teams won't be tolerated .

Links and Contacts

Registration form	http://iutictfest26.tech/datathon
Contact for queries	Abdullah Al Jubaer Event head, Datathon 01736-587392
Competition Link	Will be updated later
Discord Link	https://discord.gg/agVn3E3Nr

Prize Pool Breakdown

Champion: BDT 50K

1st Runner Up: BDT 35K

2nd Runner Up: BDT 20K

Best Efficiency: BDT 10K

Best Paper: BDT 5K

Scoring System:(May be updated later)

- Online Round (70% of total ; Derived from evaluation metric)
 - Public Leaderboard (30% of online score)
 - Private Leaderboard (70% of online score)
- Offline Round (30% of total)
 - Presentation (Methodology and Novelty of the approach) (50% of offline score)
 - Q&A (30% of offline score)
 - Documentation / Report (20% of offline score)
- Overall scoring scheme
 - Total = $0.7 \times (\text{online score}) + 0.3 \times (\text{offline score})$
 - Online score = $0.3 \times \text{public leaderboard score} + 0.7 \times \text{private leaderboard score}$
 - Offline score = $0.5 \times \text{presentation score} + 0.3 \times \text{Q\&A} + 0.2 \times \text{report score}$

Judging Criteria:

- Presentation:
 - Clear explanation of assumptions, models, and decisions
 - Informatics and Visualization of the experiments
 - Novelty of the approach
 - Team's' ability to articulate their contributions
- Q&A:
 - Problem Understanding & Motivation
 - Data & Preprocessing
 - Modeling & Methodology
 - Evaluation & Metrics
 - Novelty & Insights
- Report and Documentation:
 - Methodology and Explanation
 - Data visualization and informatics
 - References for the methodology
 - References for new datasets used (If applicable)
- For **Best Efficiency** and **Best Paper** the evaluation criteria is different which will be disclosed when competition starts.

For any sort of questions and confusions please ask in the discord server.